

Uttar Pradesh Scripts a New Green Future

Through mega plantation drives, wetland conservation, Green Schools, Eco Clubs and tree asset management initiatives, the Yogi Government is transforming environmental conservation into a people's movement across Uttar Pradesh.

Guided by the vision of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, 'Vriksharopan Mahayagya 2026' has evolved into a mass movement. Under the "**Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam"** campaign, a record over 35.27 crore saplings were planted across Uttar Pradesh on 12 July. The plantation drive was carried out in coordination with all divisions and districts of the state, involving every department as well as social and educational institutions. As part of this initiative, the Forest, Environment and Climate Change Department planted the highest number of saplings, with over 15,42,19,413 plantations. This was followed by the Rural Development Department, which achieved plantation of more than 10.56 crore saplings. Among the districts, Sonbhadra secured the top position by planting 1.68 crore saplings, followed by Lalitpur, Jhansi, Lakhimpur Kheri and Jalaun in the second, third, fourth and fifth positions, respectively. Among all species, Shisham accounted for the highest number of plantations, with over 4.67 crore saplings planted. Among fruit-bearing trees, Jamun emerged as the most widely planted species. Vriksharopan Mahayagya 2026 is translating Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's vision of a Green Uttar Pradesh into reality.

In Uttar Pradesh, the plantation drive has been designed to go beyond numerical targets by integrating it with broader social and cultural objectives. New concepts such as Samaras Van, Samriddhi Van, Urja Van, and Kapi Van will be developed to serve distinct ecological and developmental purposes. On the occasion of World Environment Day (5 June), the Maharshi Charak Aushadhi Van initiative has already been launched. Similarly, under Mission Chhaya, shade-giving trees will be planted along roadsides and at public places to provide relief from rising temperatures. In addition, initiatives such as Aviral Dhara Plantation, Sahjan Bhandara, and Aam Bhandara will be implemented keeping local requirements and biodiversity conservation in view. The Government has also expanded plantation into a year-round campaign. Programmes such as 'Vande Mataram Vatika' on August 15, Brother-Sister Plantation on Raksha Bandhan (28 August), and 'Ek Ped Guru Ke Naam' (One Tree in the Name of a Teacher) on Teachers' Day (5 September) seek to connect environmental conservation with social celebrations.

Extensive Green Network Takes Shape

To ensure the success of this massive campaign, the State Government has paid special attention to advance preparations. Nearly 57.62 crore saplings have been raised this year in

Plantation Mega Campaign

Year 2017-18	5.72 Crore
Year 2018-19	11.77 Crore
Year 2019-20	22.60 Crore
Year 2020-21	25.87 Crore
Year 2021-22	30.53 Crore
Year 2022-23	35.49 Crore
Year 2023-24	36.16 Crore
Year 2024-25	36.80 Crore
Year 2025-26	37.21 Crore

